

Quillforge

Forge your Markdown. See it like GitHub.

User Manual · v1.1.0

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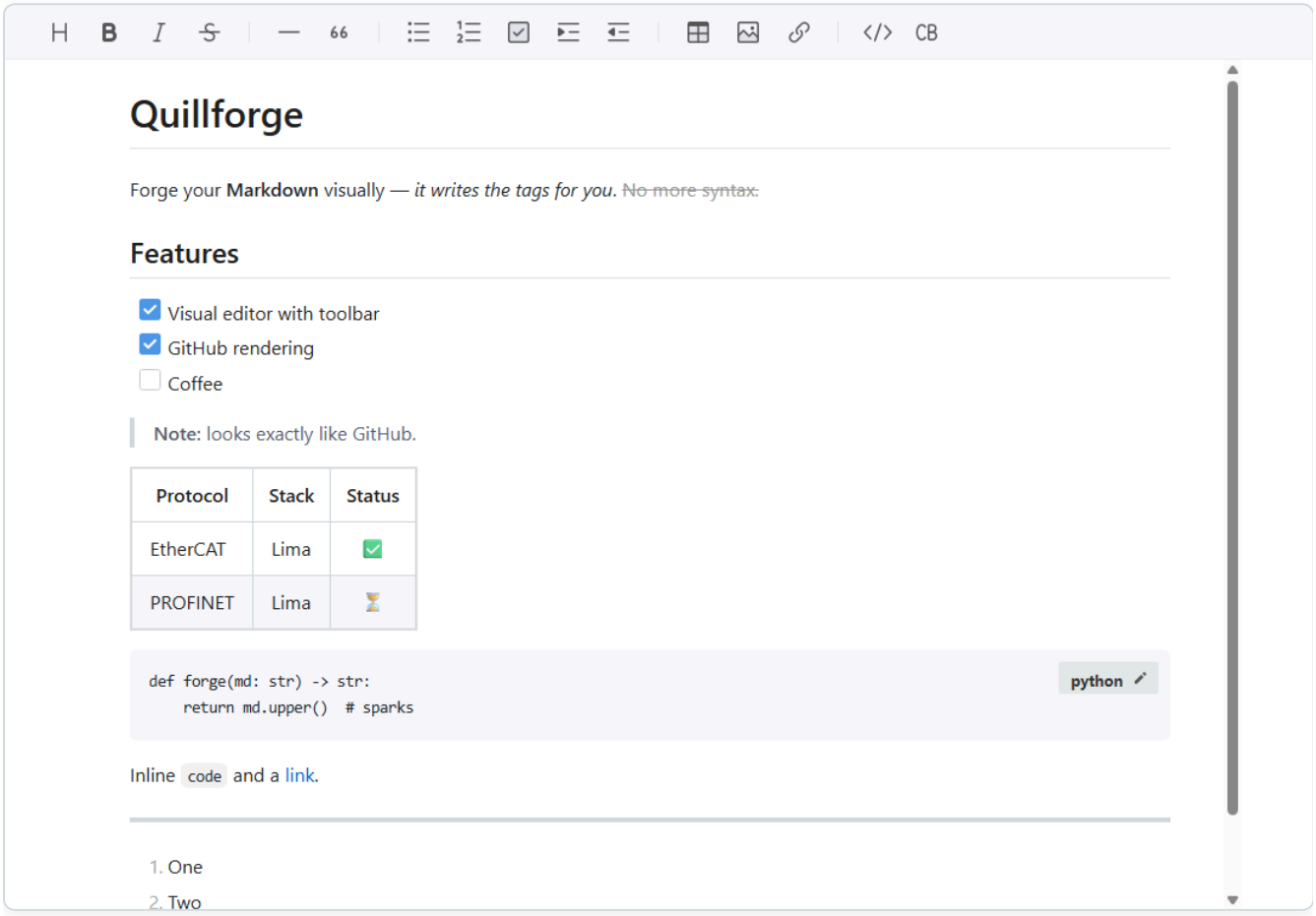
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1. What is Quillforge

Quillforge is a Markdown viewer and editor for Windows. You format text with buttons — headings, bold, lists, tables, code — and Quillforge writes the Markdown tags behind the scenes. Every document is shown exactly the way GitHub displays it, in light or dark theme.

It is designed for `README.md` files, notes, documentation and any `.md` file you want to read or edit without memorising syntax.



Visual editor: format with the toolbar, no tags in sight.

2. Installation

Run `Quillforge-Setup-1.1.0.exe`. The installer is available in English and Spanish and does **not** need administrator rights: it installs for the current user in `%LOCALAPPDATA%\Programs\Quillforge`.

Option	What it does
Desktop shortcut	Adds a Quillforge icon to the desktop.
Open .md files with Quillforge	Adds Quillforge to *Open with* for .md / .markdown files, and makes it the handler for those files for the current user.

Requirements: Windows 10 or 11 (64-bit) and Microsoft Edge WebView2 Runtime, which is already part of Windows 11. The .NET runtime is included; nothing else has to be installed.

To uninstall: *Settings → Apps → Installed apps → Quillforge → Uninstall*. Your settings in `%APPDATA%\Quillforge` are kept.

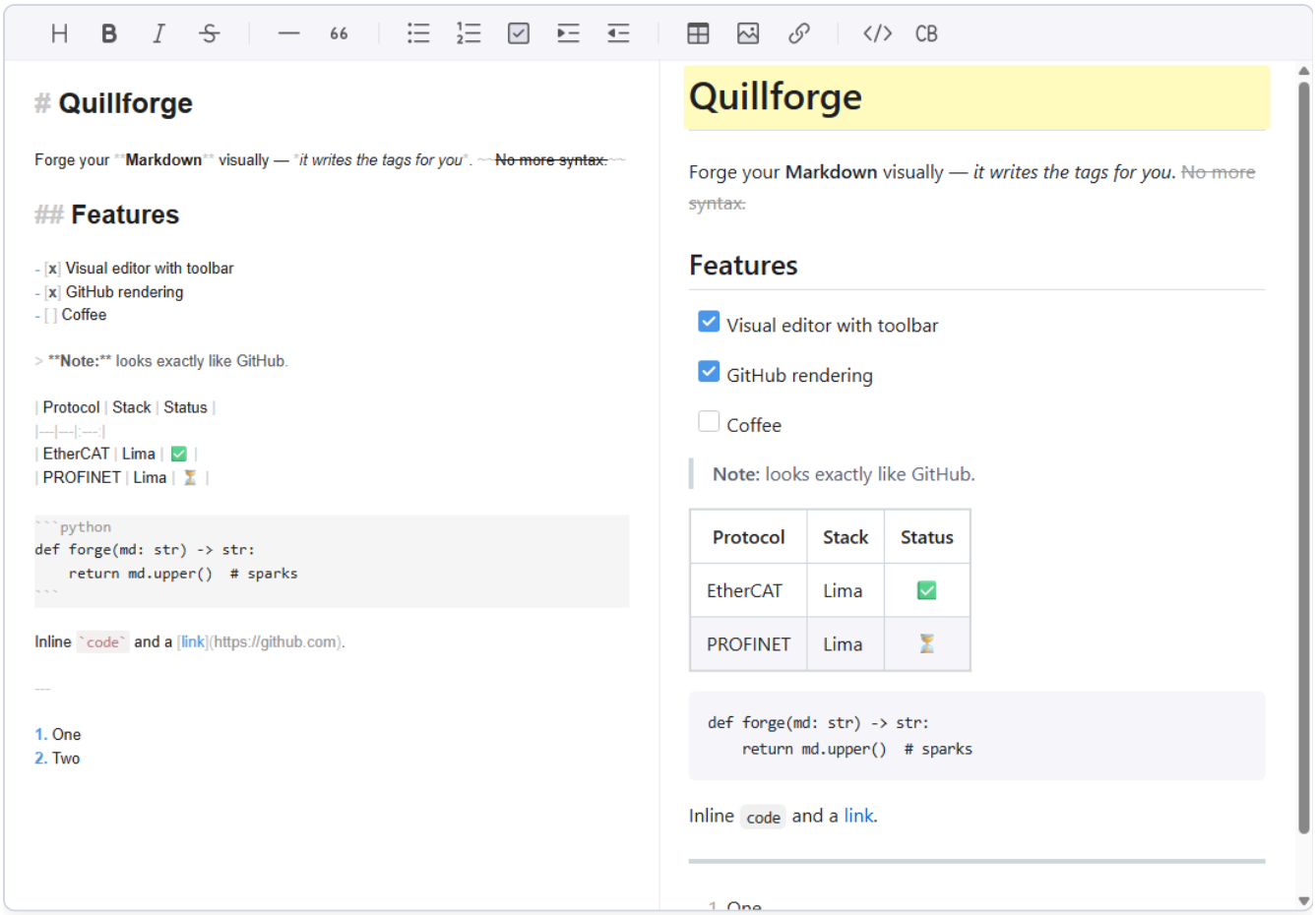
3. The window

Part	Use
Menu bar	File, Edit, Format, View, Language and Help. All menus are available in English and Spanish.
Toolbar	The formatting buttons (see below). Hidden in GitHub preview, which is read-only.
Document	The page itself, laid out with the same column width, fonts and spacing as github.com.
Status bar	File path, word count, current mode, and whether there are unsaved changes.

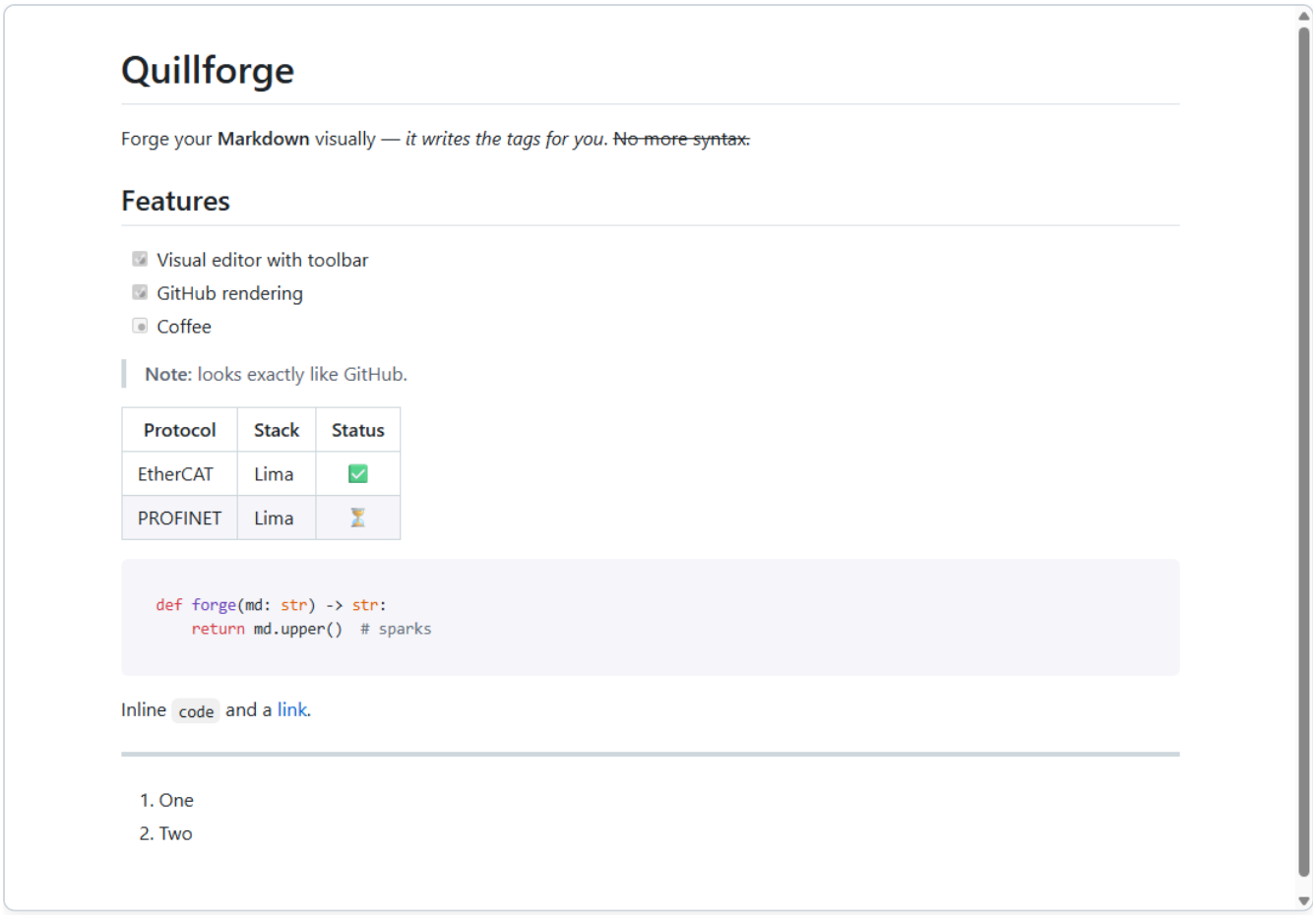
The title bar shows the file name; a ● in front of it means there are unsaved changes.

4. Three ways to see a document

Mode	Shortcut	What you see
Visual editor	`Ctrl` + `1`	The formatted document. Type and use the buttons; the Markdown is generated for you.
Markdown source	`Ctrl` + `2`	The raw Markdown on the left and a live preview on the right. For when you want to see or touch the tags.
GitHub preview	`Ctrl` + `3`	Read-only page rendered like GitHub, with syntax highlighting, task lists and clickable links.



Markdown source with live preview.



GitHub preview (light theme).

5. Formatting toolbar

Button	Action	Markdown it writes
H	Heading 1–6 or normal paragraph	`# Title` … `###### Title`
B	Bold	`**text**`
I	Italic	`*text*`
~~S~~	Strikethrough	`~~text~~`
—	Horizontal rule	`***`
❝	Quote	`> text`
• list / 1. list	Bulleted / numbered list	`- item` / `1. item`
☑	Task list	`- [ ] task`
→ / ←	Indent / outdent list item	nested list
Table	Insert table (choose rows × columns)	`| a | b |`
Image	Insert image from URL or file name	`![alt](file.png)`
Link	Insert link	`[text](https://…)`
</>	Inline code	`` `code` ``
CB	Code block (choose language for colouring)	` ```python `

The same actions are in the **Format** menu. Right-click inside a table to add or delete rows and columns, or to align a column.

6. Files

Action	How
Open	*File* → *Open* (`Ctrl` + `O`), double-click a .md file, or drag a file onto the window.
Recent files	*File* → *Open recent* keeps the last 12 files.
Save / Save as	`Ctrl` + `S` / `Ctrl` + `Shift` + `S`. New files are saved as UTF-8 without BOM, the same as GitHub; existing files keep their encoding and line endings.
New / New window	`Ctrl` + `N` starts an empty document; *New window* opens a second Quillforge.
Show in folder	Opens Explorer with the file selected.

If you close a document with unsaved changes, Quillforge asks whether to save them.

Images and links

Relative paths work as on GitHub: `![diagram](img/diagram.png)` shows the image stored next to the .md file. In GitHub preview, links to web pages open in your browser, links to other `.md` files open in Quillforge, and `#heading` links jump inside the document.

7. Export and print

Export to HTML saves a single, self-contained HTML page with the GitHub style embedded — ready to e-mail or publish.

Print / PDF (`Ctrl`+`P`) prints the GitHub-style page. Choose *Save as PDF* as the printer to create a PDF.

8. Working tools

Feature	How it works
Find / Replace	`Ctrl`+`F` / `Ctrl`+`H` open a bar above the document. `F3` and `Shift`+`F3` jump between matches; `Esc` closes it. *Aa* matches case.
Outline	`Ctrl`+`Shift`+`O` or the first toolbar button shows the headings on the left; click one to jump to it.
Your formatting is kept	Only the lines you change are rewritten when you save: list markers, `__bold__`, table alignment, line endings (CRLF/LF) and BOM stay as they were.
Changed outside	If another program modifies the open file, Quillforge reloads it (or asks first if you have unsaved changes).
Crash recovery	Unsaved work is backed up every 20 seconds. If Quillforge or Windows stops unexpectedly, the next start offers to recover it.
Spell check	*View* → *Spell check* underlines misspelled words (Windows dictionaries).
One window per file	Opening a .md while Quillforge is running brings the existing window forward instead of starting a second copy. *File* → *New window* still opens another one.
Updates	Quillforge checks once a day for a new version; *Help* → *Check for updates* does it on demand.

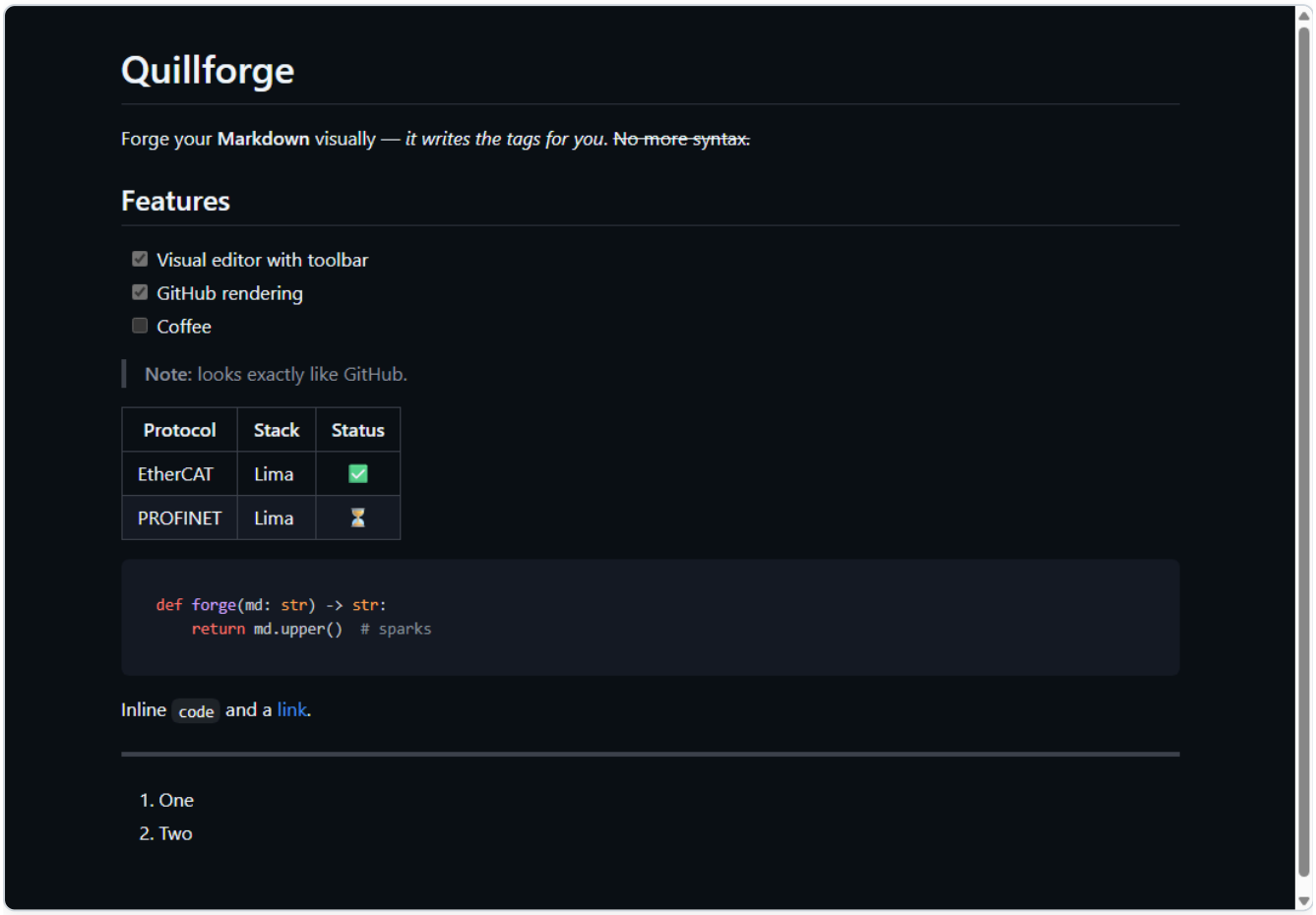
GitHub extras

Also rendered exactly like GitHub: alerts (`> [!NOTE]`, `[!TIP]`, `[!IMPORTANT]`, `[!WARNING]`, `[!CAUTION]`), ```` ```mermaid ```` diagrams, math (`$E=mc^2$` and `$$ … $$`), footnotes (`[^1]`) and emoji shortcodes (`:rocket:`).

9. Language, theme and zoom

Language menu: English or Español. It changes the menus, the toolbar tooltips and dialogs immediately. The first time, Quillforge follows the Windows language.

View → **Dark theme** switches between GitHub light and GitHub dark. Zoom with `Ctrl`+`+`, `Ctrl`+`-` and `Ctrl`+`0`. Language, theme, mode, zoom and window size are remembered.



GitHub dark theme.

10. Keyboard shortcuts

Keys	Action	Keys	Action
`Ctrl`+`N`	New	`Ctrl`+`B`	Bold
`Ctrl`+`O`	Open	`Ctrl`+`I`	Italic
`Ctrl`+`S`	Save	`Ctrl`+`Z` / `Ctrl`+`Y`	Undo / Redo
`Ctrl`+`Shift`+`S`	Save as	`Ctrl`+`1`/`2`/`3`	Visual / Source / GitHub
`Ctrl`+`P`	Print / PDF	`Ctrl`+`+` / `-` / `0`	Zoom
`Ctrl`+`W`	Close window	`F1`	This manual
`Ctrl`+`F` / `H`	Find / Replace	`F3` / `Shift`+`F3`	Next / previous match
`Ctrl`+`Shift`+`O`	Outline	`Esc`	Close find bar

11. Technical information

Item	Detail
Version	1.1.0
License	GNU GPL version 2 only (GPL-2.0-only) — free software, no warranty. Full text: `LICENSE.txt` in the program folder.
Platform	.NET 8 (WPF, self-contained) + Microsoft Edge WebView2
Editor	TOAST UI Editor 3.2 (MIT)
GitHub rendering	marked (GitHub Flavored Markdown), highlight.js, github-markdown-css (MIT)
Icon	Griffin from Martin Schongauer's engraving (c. 1485), The Metropolitan Museum of Art, CC0; quill added.
Settings	`%APPDATA%\Quillforge\settings.json`
Source code	`src/` in the project folder; build with `build.ps1`.

> The visual editor normalises some details when it writes Markdown (for example, `*` lists become `-`). The text and the way GitHub displays it do not change.